

COOL Tip Sheet

It is important to remember that selling seafood under the correct item number is a company policy in compliance with Federal Labeling Laws under the COOL Act. The majority of the time we are doing a great job but errors still occur weekly.

Below you will find valuable information which will enable all Meat Department employees to work within the realm of compliance.

1. Always have a COOL reference sheet printed and readily available near any scale on which seafood is labeled, including roadshow scales.
2. The COOL sheet is updated any time we have a New Country of Origin scenario. The most current copy is always posted on the Meat Department's intranet home page.
3. We have requested that all vendors put the appropriate PLU numbers on our scale labels for two reasons:
 - a.) To make it easier and faster operationally to locate the proper PLU number.
 - b.) In anticipation of the IS Department making programming changes requiring the Receiving Department to enter a PLU number in the system when receiving seafood. We can then have a record in the AS400 specific to Country of Origin information in the event of an inspection.

Vendors can make mistakes, thus it is very important that whoever is trayng up the seafood reads the label description. That person needs to be sure it coincides with the box description. Vendors are more likely to make an error on the PLU number than on the item description.

The only exceptions to COOL labeling include **cooked items** (King and Dungeness Crab, etc.) and **value added items** (Stuffed Salmon, Breaded Tilapia, etc.).

Only U.S. state names can legally be used instead of "Product of USA."
For example, a box says "*Wild Copper River Sockeye Salmon Fillet, Product of Alaska.*"
The label prints "*Wild Copper River Sockeye Salmon Fillet, Product of USA.*"
This is acceptable and perfectly legal.